

AI is taking the You out of YouTube

In 2005, when the internet was young — accessed mostly through dial-up connections and **featuring** user-created websites — the birth of YouTube **heralded** a new **era** of digital content creation, and creativity. In **grainy footage**, shot in low-light conditions and **against make-shift backdrops**, ordinary people offered a **glimpse** into their lives, their **nerdy obsessions** and **passions**. Would-be musicians, artists and filmmakers **showcased** their craft, with many, like singers Justin Bieber, Shawn Mendes and Troye Sivan, finding **stardom**. This was the promise of YouTube, when the “you” in its name meant something. Twenty years on, however, with AI entering the chat, that promise is becoming increasingly **fragile**.

“**AI slop**” — purely AI-generated content, usually **nonsensical**, with no **substance** and storyline or any purpose other than **grabbing** clicks and views — **is taking over** YouTube. A recent data **analysis** by The Guardian **found** that “nearly one in 10 of the fastest growing YouTube channels globally are showing AI-generated content only”, with many of the channels posting “repetitive and ‘inauthentic’ content”. A platform once celebrated as **a launch pad** for everyman is now being **crowded with** content that is **disconnected** from anyone’s **lived** experience and which lacks the textures and **tones** of human creativity, the **telling flaws** and **endearing glitches** that speak of people, not **algorithms**.

The **proliferation** of blindly-automated, **prompt-driven** creations **means** that creators will now have to **compete** for views and — increasingly, ad revenue — with content-generation farms that can upload multiple, **polished** videos in a single day. It is also bad news for consumers. AI may have much to offer when used right, but no **prompt**, however **precisely** worded, **can** generate the many **shades** of human **ingenuity** and **whimsy** that YouTube is home to.

[Practice Exercise]

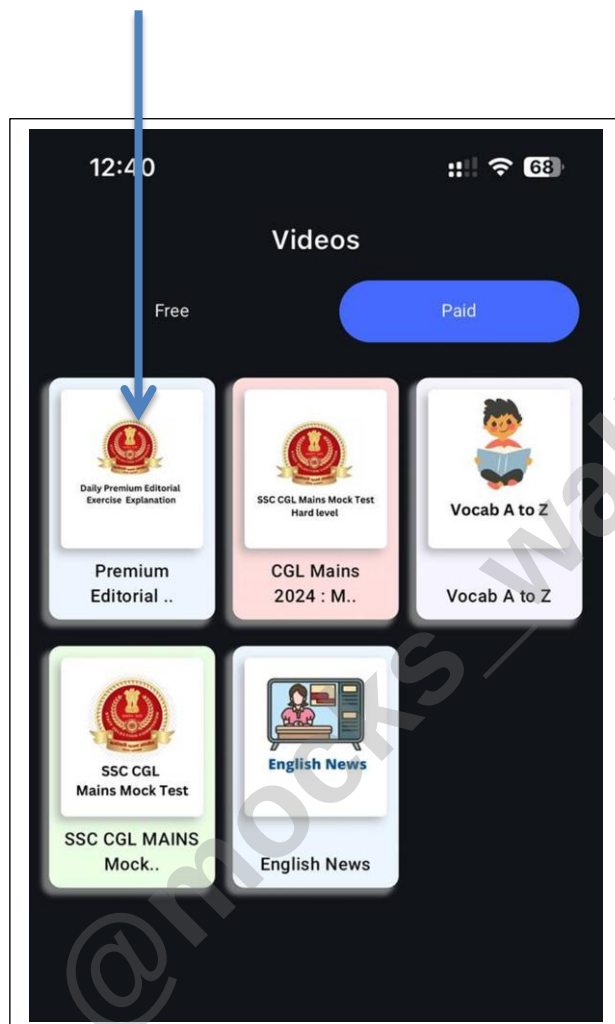
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where ‘red’ denotes ‘subject’ and ‘blue’ denotes ‘verb’.
- **AI Slop** (noun) – It refers to low-quality, often formulaic and generic, content generated by artificial intelligence

Vocabulary

1. **Feature** (verb) – include, present, showcase, highlight, host प्रस्तुत करना
2. **Herald** (verb) – announce, signal, foreshadow, usher in, proclaim आगाज़ करना
3. **Era** (noun) – epoch, age, period, timespan, aeon युग
4. **Grainy footage** (noun) – low-resolution clip, pixelated recording, noisy video, gritty footage, low-fi visuals दानेदार वीडियो
5. **Against the backdrop** (phrase) – in the context of, set against, amid, against the background of, on the canvas of की पृष्ठभूमि में
6. **Glimpse** (noun) – peek, snapshot, fleeting view, flash, look झलक
7. **Nerdy** (adjective) – characterized by great enthusiasm for and knowledge about a particular subject, especially one of specialist or niche interest. गीकी
8. **Obsession** (noun) – fixation, preoccupation, mania, infatuation, compulsion सनक
9. **Passion** (noun) – fervor, ardor, zeal, enthusiasm, fire जुनून
10. **Showcase** (verb) – exhibit, display, present, parade, highlight प्रदर्शित करना
11. **Stardom** (noun) – celebrity, fame, renown, star status, limelight ख्याति
12. **Fragile** (adjective) – delicate, tenuous, brittle, shaky, precarious नाज़ुक
13. **Nonsensical** (adjective) – absurd, meaningless, illogical, incoherent, preposterous बेतुका
14. **Substance** (noun) – depth, content, heft, gravitas, meaning सार
15. **Grabbing** (adjective) – attention-grabbing, eye-catching, sensationalist, clickbait, arresting ध्यानाकर्षक
16. **Take over** (phrasal verb) – dominate, supplant, overrun, seize control of, usurp हावी होना
17. **A launch pad** (noun) – springboard, platform, stepping-stone, takeoff point, incubator प्लेटफॉर्म
18. **Crowded** (with) (adjective) – packed with, teeming with, awash with, saturated with, overrun with भीड़भरा
19. **Disconnected** (adjective) – detached, disjointed, unmoored, alienated, out-of-touch असंबद्ध
20. **Lived** (adjective) – first-hand, experiential, real-world, authentic, grounded जीवंत

21. **Tone** (noun) – mood, tenor, timbre, register, color लहजा
22. **Telling** (adjective) – revealing, indicative, significant, pointed, suggestive प्रकटकारी
23. **Flaw** (noun) – defect, blemish, imperfection, fault, shortcoming खामी
24. **Endearing** (adjective) – lovable, charming, winsome, appealing, sweet प्यारा
25. **Glitch** (noun) – bug, hiccup, snag, malfunction, error तकनीकी त्रुटि
26. **Algorithm** (noun) – a process or set of rules to be followed in calculations or other problem-solving operations, especially by a computer.
27. **Proliferation** (noun) – spread, surge, explosion, boom, mushrooming विस्तार
28. **Prompt-driven** (adjective) – instruction-led, input-driven, prompt-based, text-cued, command-led प्रॉम्प्ट-आधारित
29. **Compete** (for) (verb) – vie for, contend for, jockey for, battle for, fight for प्रतिस्पर्धा करना
30. **Polished** (adjective) – slick, refined, well-produced, glossy, well-edited परिष्कृत
31. **Prompt** (noun) – cue, instruction, input, command, text prompt निर्देश
32. **Precisely** (adverb) – exactly, accurately, meticulously, scrupulously, with exactitude सटीक रूप से
33. **Shade** (noun) – nuance, subtlety, gradation, hue, tint सूक्ष्मता
34. **Ingenuity** (noun) – inventiveness, resourcefulness, creativity, cleverness, originality सूझ-बूझ
35. **Whimsy** (noun) – playfully quaint or fanciful behaviour or humour. खेल-भाव

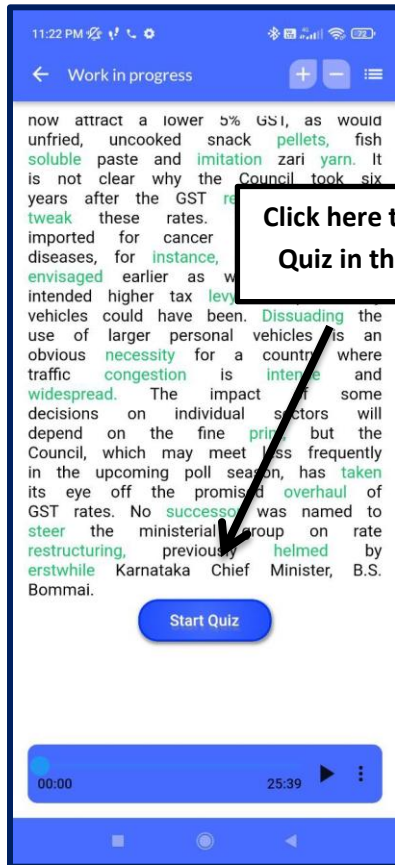
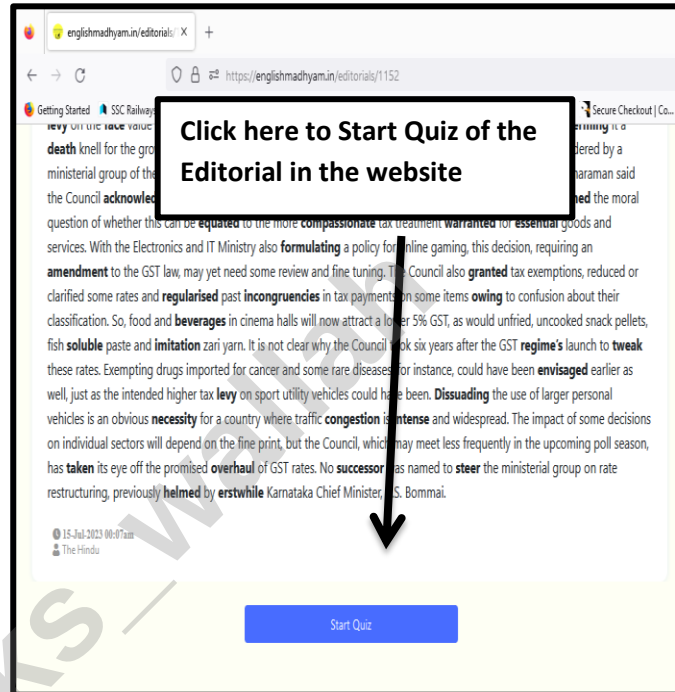
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. YouTube, launched in 2005, was built on user-generated content and personal creativity.
2. Early videos were often raw, unpolished, and personal, reflecting genuine human lives and passions.
3. The platform enabled ordinary people to showcase talents, leading some, like Justin Bieber and Shawn Mendes, to stardom.
4. The “You” in YouTube once symbolized authentic individual expression.
5. Today, AI-generated content (“AI slop”) is flooding the platform.
6. Such content is often meaningless, repetitive, and lacks narrative substance.
7. A Guardian analysis showed that 1 in 10 of the fastest-growing YouTube channels post only AI-generated videos.
8. Many of these channels create inauthentic and formulaic content.
9. This shift undermines YouTube’s original spirit of human-driven creativity.
10. The flaws, quirks, and textures of real human creators are missing in AI videos.
11. Automated content farms can mass-produce polished videos daily, outpacing individual creators.
12. This creates unfair competition for views and ad revenue between humans and machines.
13. For audiences, AI-heavy content means less originality, relatability, and emotional resonance.
14. While AI has potential, it cannot replace the spontaneity, imagination, and unique perspective of human creativity.
15. The editorial warns that YouTube risks losing its identity as a people-driven platform, with algorithms replacing authenticity.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based

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